

The practice began in 1924, following the Acworth Committee Report recommendations (see [Reforming and Restructuring](#)). Yet, it was believed that over the decades, it had become a mere “ritual” with no real advantages. It was becoming apparent that the railways was trying to leave its colonial past behind. A merged budget meant that the Indian Railways could now increase its capital expenditure and focus on generating revenue, while its functional autonomy remained unaffected.

Speed

Punctuality and speed has always been a matter of importance and the focus on increasing the speed of long-distance trains and the [Vande Bharat Express](#) is proof of this. Studies are being conducted to set up high-speed rail corridors to provide bullet train services across the country with work underway to develop a Mumbai–Ahmedabad corridor.

Carrying freight

Equal emphasis is being laid on freight services as the railways has always lost out to the road sector, leading to a significant decrease in the market share. [Dedicated freight corridors](#), however, seek to change that as they will increase the railways’ capacity to meet demand and improve the quality of services. Efforts are on to improve the railways’ connectivity to ports as well and to modernize and upgrade the systems to allow cargo tracking and punctual deliveries.

Going green

The Indian Railways has announced often that it aims to become a “net zero” carbon emitter by 2030. The process of electrification has been underway in order to make the railways run on electricity completely. In 2018, the railways commissioned its first state-of-the-art 12,000 HP electric locomotive as a part of the “Make in India” project.

In another first, the Diesel Locomotive Works (DLR) in Varanasi converted a diesel locomotive into an electric one. The railways has undertaken compressed natural gas (CNG) substitution for Diesel